karma, and good conduct, self-restraint, mercy and generosity as virtues. Despite the ritual dominated aspects of Vedic life, some seers were in pursuit of knowledge and virtuous conduct.



Dara Shukoh, the Mughal prince, translated the Upanishads into Persian in 1657, much before the colonial scholars developed any interest in ancient Indian literature.

Other aspects of Life

The Late Vedic culture has evidence of music and fine arts. Music instruments such as lute, flute and drum are referred to in the texts. With the development of cultivation and pastoralism, different types of food and drinks made of grains, milk and ghee and plants were consumed. Evidence of the use of silk and ornaments of metal, gold and copper is found. Metal mirrors were also used. The archaeological sites have uncovered beads and ornaments and the fabrication of glass beads was also developed in the later part of the Vedic period.

Characteristics of Later Vedic Society

Later Vedic period is marked by lineages of clans, and small kingdoms developed in many parts of the Ganga valley, leading to the development of the state after 600 BCE. The idea of janapada and rashtra as territorial units had developed. The raja wielded much power and the social divisions began to strike deep roots. The varna system had developed well.

SUMMARY

- After the decline of the Indus Civilization numerous cultures developed across north India. Copper, followed by iron, came to be widely used. Iron helped to expand areas of cultivation leading to agrarian surplus. As this facilitated feeding of more number of people there were greater instances of in-migration and population growth. The Late Harappan cultures suggest that some of the groups moved into eastern direction, after the decline of the Indus Civilization.
- The Chalcolithic culture, including the OCP cultures, flourished in different parts of India.
- The Aryans migrated to India around 1500 BCE. The Vedic texts form an important source of this period.
- The Rig Veda, the earliest text in Sanskrit, portrays the society and culture of the early Vedic period.
- The Later Vedic period for which Yajur, Sama and Atharva Vedas are the source, evolved into a complex and rigid society.



EXERCISE



I. Choose the correct answer

1. The main collection of vedic hymns are called
   (a) Brahmanas (b) Samhita
   (c) Aranyakas (d) Upanishads
2. The land of Upper Ganga Doab region was described as
   (a) Kuru-panchalas (b) Ganga valley
   (c) Indus valley (d) Videha
3. Adichanallur is situated in _____ district
   (a) Coimbatore (b) Erode
   (c) Thothukudi (d) Vellore
4. Consider the following:
   (i) Senani - chief of the army
   (ii) Gramani - village head
   (iii) Bali - voluntary contribution
   (iv) Purohita - governor
   Which one of the pair is incorrect?
   (a) i (b) ii (c) iii (d) iv
5. **Assertion (A) :** There is no evidence of child marriage in Early Vedic period
   Reason (R) : Women had been excluded from rituals in the later Vedic period

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